



What is Snapchat?

After 4 years of its launch, Snapchat CEO released an extra low quality video explaining how it works <http://dgit.in/snapchatvid>



From running to twitter

Sonic the Hedgehog now has an official Twitter handle where he posts funny replies to fans. See more: <http://dgit.in/snctwttr>

Industry Connect

the lives of 800 million people from the less well off bracket, e-healthcare and e-education are two big, mighty subjects. Lots of entrepreneurs are innovating around these, and certainly there are several billion-dollar businesses that are sure to be created in the coming years. Finally, and particularly important for India is Utility Management and Machine-to-Machine communication.

Demand side energy management is particularly important for markets that find it difficult to produce their own energy and have infrastructure problems to deliver energy.

To answer your question fully, the negative trend that kind of troubles me is around net neutrality. This whole issue has come to the forefront in the last month or so in India. I've been very vocal about this from New Call's perspective around how we view that in the global context. I look at the traditional telecom model, and it's got to change.

Let's look at what happened in the early 1800s in England where people were moving from transportation which was canal-barges to move coal around the country, to trains. Can we stop progress? No. Was there an uproar? People embraced change. It's an unusual analogy, but, similarly, telecom companies in India and across the globe need to embrace change. They have to embrace over-the-top services. They either have to acquire over-the-top services to complement their future roadmap, develop over-the-top services or partner with OTT service providers, rather than try to tinker around with a fundamental norm in the global marketplace of net neutrality. So, I think that is one negative side effect of the emergence of the app era and digitalisation.

I'm not sure I understand your analogy because, what you spoke of is an entire paradigm shift in a technology. There was no way but to migrate to that other form. Here we're talking about telcos giving preferential treatment to some entities, or some applications – creating pathways that are better for certain kind of people. That is something that...

Nigel: Well, we've got 50 million small to medium-sized businesses in India. If

we tinker with the issue of net neutrality, when will they ever get online? When will they have a voice? No. The Government needs to look into that segment of entrepreneurs in India that contributes over 50% of GDP today in India. We've got to look after them. Net neutrality and tinkering with net neutrality will be fatal for that segment that really underpins 50 million traditional SMBs. There's hundreds of millions of entrepreneurs in India who will want to come online, at one point or another. It's got to be fair and equitable to all. We can't give preference to others that can afford to pay, in my opinion.

Vikas: I think the apps which would start saving money or give you better data speed would be something that might come up. And right now, there would be businesses that would tinker with the overall data business that is being carried out in the country or anywhere in the world.

Bobby Sarin: Just to add to what Vikas has said, there's also a new solution that we're launching in India with a partner company around entertainment. It's about micro-caching content at locations. So imagine this scenario: you can go to a McDonalds, download a two-and-a-half hour movie without any broadband costs. This would normally take you about 60-90 minutes at home and you'd still have to pay for your broadband. But here it would take you merely 5-10 minutes. So, these disruptive type of solutions coming into the market will be key to changing the trend.

What's your take on regulated markets like India. Is the TRAI's framework supportive to new initiatives or is it an issue dealing with them?

Bobby Sarin: I think they're also learning along the way. There are more challenges in India than other markets in terms of protecting the consumer, protecting connections and knowing what the consumer is doing. For example, in the US, McDonalds can provide its own Wi-Fi without any validation checks. Starbucks does the same. In India, if you want to provide public Wi-Fi you need an ISP license, you need to register the user's mobile number and you also need to monitor the user's activity

and keep logs for five years. So, the security measures in India are a lot more stringent than they're in the West. If I were to ask myself "are the regulators doing what they should be doing?" I think they are. That makes life a little complex for us, but after terrorism incidents in Mumbai such as when a terrorist sent a message from an open public network, I think they're necessary. For two years after that incident, I had to fight an argument in the market that Wi-Fi is not associated with terrorism! I think the regulators are learning fast, they're putting more checkpoints in place, but it's healthy for the market.

Speaking of acquisitions, when will we see huge startups coming from India?

Vikas: You're now seeing the early days of that happening. Engineering and product mindset was lacking in this country for a long period of time. We were largely a services-oriented company wherein we did work for clients. This mindset is now rapidly getting developed, both – because of the successes that you see here (because success births success) and because a lot of people who lived in the Silicon Valley primarily are coming back to India and they're bringing their skillset with them. So these two or three big trends are coming together. First one is Venture Capitalism. Some people say it's just a bubble, but it's available. Earlier it wasn't. Second, the number of users who will take your service fast has gone up. I have been in a company before Nimbuzz also. One of the biggest constraints you had with the internet in 2006 was that when you launched a service it took a lot of time to scale. By that time the employees lose interest, investors lose interest and so on. That's completely changed now. I gave you the example of Hola with 10,000 downloads a day, but there was a time when we didn't have 10,000 downloads even in six months. And third, like I said, a product-oriented mindset is coming in. This is the primordial soup: Market, capital, talent – everything is there. **I**

For the full interview covering aspects such as the ubiquitous Wi-Fi, the Hola app and more, visit this shortlink: <http://dgit.in/ncallnbz> or Blipp this page.